Basic Criteria for Great Scheduling

Rule 1: Document the Scheduling Methodology

Rule 2: The Schedule Should cover Complete Scope

Rule 3: Level-of-Effort Activities to be used with caution

Rule 4: Activities Should Have Unique Names

Rule 5: Verbs to be included in Activity Names

Rule 6: Each Activity Should Have At least One Predecessor and One Successor

Rule 7: Follow schedule checks using codes like DCMA-14-point assessment

Rule 8: To the extent possible Most Relationships should be FS

Rule 9: Avoid SF Relationships

Rule 10: Use limited and logical Lags

Rule 11: Relationships should not lead to circular references

Rule 12: Define and stick to clean criteria for flat limits and critical paths

Rule 13: Multiple critical paths should be tracked exclusively

Rule 14: Have a limit on length of durations and floats

Rule 15: Do not Split Activities

Rule 16: Avoid constraints in between First and Last activity on the schedule

Rule 17: Limit use of constraints if un avoidable to milestones only

Rule 18: Follow well documented and well authorized baselining criteria from the start

Rule 19: Maintain schedule snapshots to allow for retrieval of valuable historic data

Rule 20: Respect periodic update cycles

Rule 21: Driving resources form a good working practice for weighing activities

Rule 22: Avoid loading indirect resources and single weightage factors as resources

Rule 23: Don’t limit scheduling to the Planning Team – create all round Buy-In from all

Rule 24: Periodically relay the schedule outputs to all stakeholders

Rule 25: A progressing project is always a record book of unfolding unknowns. A schedule must facilitate that visibility continually otherwise it’s a redundant schedule